DAILY

Daily World Events Intelligence Summary — 2026-10-26

DTG 260725 CDT OCT 26

PERIOD 2026-10-25 ~0725 CT to 2026-10-26 ~0725 CT

daily intel world-events US-impact economy Minnesota-costs Iran Hormuz IRGC UKMTO 182-26 CENTCOM Brad-Cooper mine-clearance Sirik Pezeshkian Ghalibaf Mecca-pact Khalid-bin-Salman Asim-Munir Ibrahim-Kalin Mohsen-Rezaei Tehran-talks NYT DNI US-diplomats Saudi-Arabia Houthis Riyadh King-Khalid-Airport Khamis-Mushait Saudi-coalition-strikes travel-restrictions Germany Gem-No-2 UAE-oil-spill oil Brent WTI futures FOMC Warsh earnings gas-prices gold Russia Ukraine Oleshky Voronezh Michigan Port-Huron El-Sayed Mike-Rogers Somalia Ninth-Circuit California-ballots Judge-Carter Ilhan-Omar Minnesota Renee-Good Alex-Pretti Israel-election midterms

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DAILY WORLD EVENTS INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY
DTG: 260725 CDT OCT 26 (America/Chicago)
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

No US strike on Iran was reported this period. Trump told Fox News on Sunday, “I have a decision to make: Do I finish it off, which would be very easy to do, or do I make a deal?” and later told reporters, “There will not be a strike today.” CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper flew over the Strait of Hormuz on Sunday; CENTCOM says the international shipping lanes have been cleared of IRGC mines and that the US has helped Gulf partners export more than 1.5 billion barrels since summer. UKMTO posted Warning 182-26 on 26 OCT, a time-late verified report that an outbound tanker was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait on 23 OCT and disabled; the crew are safe. On Monday, Saudi Defense Minister Khalid bin Salman, Pakistan’s Field Marshal Munir, and Turkish intelligence chief Kalin are in Tehran meeting Pezeshkian and SNSC secretary Rezaei as the Mecca pact states try to head off renewed war. The NYT reports two Iranian officials, one IRGC, confirmed Tehran is preparing to target US diplomats and personnel, and the US Embassy in Riyadh further restricted staff travel. Saudi Arabia intercepted 10 Houthi ballistic missiles toward the south plus a missile and drone toward Riyadh on Sunday (two hurt in Khamis Mushait), the Riyadh airport reopened two terminals, and the Houthis fired at it again Monday morning; the Saudi-led coalition says it destroyed four launchers and five missile tunnels. Oil eased Sunday night (Brent ~$115, WTI ~$102) and stock futures rose ahead of the FOMC (27–28 OCT). Russia hit Ukraine with 4 missiles and 140 drones overnight; the Oleshky ceasefire is due to start 27 OCT. In Michigan, Trump called Democratic Senate nominee Abdul El-Sayed a “jihadist.” A Ninth Circuit panel sounded skeptical of DOJ’s bid to set aside about 20,000 California ballots; no ruling yet. Minnesota: no new court action on Omar or the Good/Pretti evidence dispute. MN regular is $4.1921 and diesel $6.2193 (AAA 26 OCT); gold ~$4,019; debt $40.444T (22 OCT, no new posting).

ITEM 1: Iran Strike Track and US Posture — Trump: “I Have a Decision to Make,” “There Will Not Be a Strike Today”; CENTCOM Commander Visits Hormuz, Says Shipping Lanes Cleared of Mines

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

In a Fox News interview aired Sunday 25 OCT, Trump said, “I have a decision to make: Do I finish it off, which would be very easy to do, or do I make a deal? That’s the decision,” adding, “We don’t play games” (The National). Before boarding Air Force One for Michigan, he told reporters, “The answer is no. There will not be a strike today” (Times of Israel; Iran International; AP). Bloomberg quoted him as saying it is “getting to be decision time.” Adm. Brad Cooper, head of CENTCOM, visited the Strait of Hormuz on 25 OCT. CENTCOM said US forces have “successfully cleared the strait’s international shipping lanes of sea mines” laid by the IRGC and that the US has helped Gulf partners export “more than 1.5 billion barrels” since summer. Cooper said, “We continue to stand shoulder to shoulder with our Gulf partners and the shipping industry” (CENTCOM statement via The National). Al Jazeera

summarized the planning picture: The Hill's report that CENTCOM has follow-up strike options ready, Axios's earlier report that the Pentagon told CENTCOM to finish preparations for possible major combat (targets could include energy facilities, infrastructure, and nuclear sites), and the NYT's report of joint US–Israeli plans for after the midterms. None of these amounts to an order. Trump has said he would not strike before the 03 NOV election. Israel votes Tuesday, 27 OCT.

US IMPACT ASSESSMENT

Trump is now framing the choice publicly as binary, deal or "finish it off," while ruling out strikes day by day. Cooper's visit and the mine-clearance claim are meant to reassure shippers and markets that the strait is usable even without a deal. The highest-risk window still looks like the period after 03 NOV, but the President has kept the timing open.

SOURCE SYNOPSIS

The National (Fox interview quotes, CENTCOM statement, 25 OCT); Times of Israel, Iran International, AP (no strike "today," 25 OCT); Bloomberg via swissinfo ("decision time"); Al Jazeera explainer (25 OCT).

MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)

TheBlaze's Sunday clips focused on Trump's Michigan rally rather than Iran. No Iran strike coverage was found from Daily Wire, Timcast, Crowder, Glenn Beck, or S2 Underground this period.

MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)

AP led with Iran saying messages are still passing to the US alongside Trump's "not today." Al Jazeera quoted Chatham House's Julie Norman calling the plans both "an immediate posturing deterrent" and "a very real option" after the election.

CONFIDENCE

HIGH on Trump's quotes (on camera, multiple outlets). HIGH on the CENTCOM statement (official, via The National). HIGH that no US strike was reported this period.

ITEM 2: Iran Diplomacy — Saudi, Pakistani, and Turkish Leaders in Tehran Monday; Iran Says Messages to the US Continue; Ghalibaf Warns of a Response "Beyond the Imagination"; Iran Warns Germany

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

On 26 OCT, Saudi Defense Minister Prince Khalid bin Salman, Pakistan's army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir, and Turkish intelligence chief Ibrahim Kalin are in Tehran to meet President Pezeshkian and Supreme National Security Council secretary Mohsen Rezaei. Saudi deputy minister for public diplomacy Rayed Krimly said the visit is part of the Mecca Joint Defense Agreement states' efforts at "deescalation between parties involved in the ongoing crisis" and supports Qatar's and Pakistan's mediation (Arab News; Reuters via Al-Monitor; RFE/RL; AP). Reuters says it is the first high-level contact between Iran and all three pact members since the Houthis escalated against Saudi Arabia. SNSC deputy Ali Bagheri Kani said the meeting was Munir's proposal (Mehr). RFE/RL notes Pakistan ratified the pact last week and Turkey's parliament has not. AP reports Iran said on 25 OCT that messages are still being passed to the US and Tehran remains open to diplomacy. Parliament Speaker Ghalibaf told a 25 OCT session that any violation of Iran's territory would draw a response "beyond the imagination" of its enemies and urged the US to withdraw (X News summary of his remarks). Iran International reports Tasnim's source rejected any "Strait of Hormuz in exchange for the blockade" formula and said Iran stands by its seven conditions; Iran International notes the denial targeted Al Arabiya's report, not the ambassador's remarks to AP. Fars warned that German bases in the region would become legitimate targets if Berlin joins action against Iran, after a Hamburg court jailed two men prosecutors tied to the Quds Force and Germany summoned Iran's ambassador (X News summary).

US IMPACT ASSESSMENT

The Tehran meeting is the most senior regional mediation effort yet and includes Saudi Arabia, which is under Houthi fire. It offers a possible channel for a deal before any US decision, but Iran's public line is still its seven conditions, with no Hormuz-for-blockade trade. A Saudi role also matters because a US strike would put Saudi territory and Gulf bases at further risk.

SOURCE SYNOPSIS	Arab News and Krimly's X post (26 OCT); Reuters via Al-Monitor; RFE/RL live blog; AP (25 and 26 OCT, read through search summaries); Mehr; Iran International (25 OCT); X News summaries (Ghalibaf, Germany).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	No right-leaning coverage of the Tehran meeting was found. Conservative X accounts amplified the IRGC's September open letter urging Americans to reject Trump as proof Iran favors Democrats (X News summary).
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	AP framed the visit as an effort "to try to avert renewed fighting," noting anxiety in Iran about a return to all-out war. RFE/RL and Al-Monitor emphasized the Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia as the backdrop.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH that the Tehran meeting is taking place (Saudi, Iranian, and Reuters sourcing). MODERATE on Ghalibaf's and Fars's wording (via X summaries). The outcome of the meeting is not yet known.

ITEM 3: Hormuz and Gulf Shipping — UKMTO 182-26: Outbound Tanker Struck by Unknown Projectile on 23 OCT, Disabled, Crew Safe; Gem No. 2 Spill Still Spreading; Unconfirmed Sirik Launcher Strike

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	UKMTO Warning 182-26 (file dated 26 OCT) reports a "verified time-late report" of an attack in the Strait of Hormuz on 23 OCT at 0839 UTC: "A tanker transiting outbound was struck by an unknown projectile, disabling the vessel. The crew have been reported safe. There is no damage assessment or environmental impact report at present." Vessels are told to transit with caution (UKMTO PDF, read directly). No vessel is named. Al Jazeera says October has become the worst month for attacks on ships near Hormuz since the war began in February. X News summaries say the Gem No. 2 spill, which began leaking around 19 OCT, has spread to hundreds of square kilometers, with coastal closures in Umm Al Quwain, Ras Al Khaimah, and Sharjah; the Sharjah detail has not been confirmed by a primary source. Iranian activist Telegram accounts and OSINT sites report that an IRGC anti-ship missile launcher near Sirik, Hormozgan, was struck on 25 OCT minutes after firing toward the strait; neither the US nor Iran has confirmed it (see quarantine). Pakistan partially reopened the Gabd–Rimdan border crossing with Iran around 25 OCT after LPG shortages (X News summary).
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	182-26 shows the attack tempo on tankers was higher last week than real-time UKMTO postings suggested, which undercuts CENTCOM's message that the lanes are safe and keeps war-risk insurance and freight costs high. If the Sirik report is true, it would be a US or partner strike on Iranian soil before the election, a significant escalation, so it needs confirmation before it is treated as fact.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	UKMTO Warning 182-26 PDF (fetched 26 OCT); Al Jazeera (25 OCT); X News summaries (spill, Sirik, Pakistan border); OSINT613 and Newsquawk (Sirik claim, via search summaries).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	No right-leaning coverage of 182-26 or the spill was found. OSINT accounts suggested possible US fighter involvement at Sirik without confirmation.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	Al Jazeera framed October as the worst month for ship attacks. No mainstream outlet had reported 182-26 by publication time.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on 182-26 (primary document). LOW on the Sirik strike (unconfirmed activist and OSINT reporting). MODERATE on the spill's extent (summaries; earlier UAE closures were confirmed in prior dailies).

ITEM 4: Threats to US Personnel — NYT: Two Iranian Officials Confirm Tehran Preparing to Target US Diplomats; US Embassy Riyadh Tightens Staff Travel, Airport Use Needs Chief-of-Mission Approval

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	The New York Times reported (24 OCT) that two Iranian officials, one an IRGC member, confirmed Iran is preparing to target US diplomats and personnel, describing Americans as "fair game" in retaliation for US and Israeli killings of Iranian officials and their relatives (NYT via Times of Israel and Jerusalem Post). This tracks the DNI memo from Jay Clayton to

	Secretary Rubio saying Iran had “substantially increased efforts to target US personnel” with plots at “advanced stages” (Al Jazeera). On 25 OCT the US Embassy in Saudi Arabia said US government employees now need special authorization from the chief of mission to use any airport in the country, may not travel within 20 miles of the Yemen border, and need special authorization to travel to Jizan, Asir, and Najran provinces and the cities of Qatif, Yanbu, and Taif. It warned US citizens of possible attacks on airports, airspace closures, and flight cancellations (US Embassy via The National). The National reports the US issued travel warnings for Saudi Arabia and 11 other regional countries.
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	Iranian officials confirming the threat on the record, even anonymously, makes the DNI warning more concrete and raises the risk to US diplomats, contractors, and service members across the region. The Riyadh restrictions effectively limit official American movement inside Saudi Arabia to essential travel.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	NYT (23–24 OCT, via Times of Israel, Jerusalem Post, Ynet); Al Jazeera (DNI memo); The National (embassy restrictions, 25 OCT).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	No right-leaning coverage was found this period.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	The NYT framed it as “a new level of threat and fear” that risks pushing the US and Iran back to full war.
CONFIDENCE	MODERATE-HIGH on the NYT report (anonymous Iranian sources, consistent with the DNI memo). HIGH on the embassy restrictions (official notice).

ITEM 5: Houthi–Saudi / Yemen — Saudi Intercepts 10 Ballistic Missiles Toward the South and a Missile and Drone Toward Riyadh; Two Hurt in Khamis Mushait; Riyadh Airport Reopens and Is Targeted Again; Coalition Says It Destroyed Launchers and Missile Tunnels

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	On 25 OCT, coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki al-Maliki said Saudi forces intercepted a Houthi ballistic missile and a drone aimed at Riyadh, a cruise missile aimed at Khamis Mushait, and later 10 ballistic missiles fired at southern Saudi Arabia. Saudi Civil Defence said debris from two intercepted missiles in Khamis Mushait and Ahad Rafidah injured two people and damaged three residential buildings and seven vehicles. Debris from two missiles intercepted on Saturday fell in Makkah, Jeddah, Taif, and Rabigh (Al Jazeera; The National). King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh reopened on 25 OCT, with Terminal 2 for international and Terminal 1 for domestic flights, after closing on 10 OCT when a Houthi attack killed 13 and wounded more than 300. Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree called it “unsafe” and “a military target.” On the morning of 26 OCT, Saree claimed a ballistic missile attack on the airport, and al-Maliki said a missile bound for Riyadh was intercepted. Saree also claimed drone strikes on Saudi oil pumping stations. On 26 OCT al-Maliki said a coalition operation destroyed four ballistic missile launchers, five tunnels used to store missiles, and a missile depot, aimed at “cutting off Houthi militia supply lines” (Al Jazeera; AP; ABC News).
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	The Houthis are deliberately targeting the reopened airport, which keeps commercial aviation and US citizens in the kingdom at risk. Claimed hits on oil pumping stations, if confirmed, would add to supply worries already lifting oil. The coalition’s counter-strikes show Riyadh is escalating on its own, separate from any US decision.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	Al Jazeera (25 and 26 OCT); The National (25 OCT); AP Mideast roundup (26 OCT, search summary); ABC News live updates (26 OCT); coalition and Saudi Civil Defence statements on X as quoted.
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	No right-leaning coverage was found this period.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	Al Jazeera and The National framed the reopening against the Houthis’ renewed threats. AP led with the coalition’s claim to have degraded Houthi strike capability.

CONFIDENCE	HIGH on Saudi interceptions and the airport reopening (official statements, multiple outlets). LOW on Houthi claims of hits on the airport and pumping stations (Saudi says intercepted; no confirmation).

ITEM 6: US Economy / Markets — Oil Eases Sunday Night, Futures Rise; FOMC 27–28 OCT Expected to Hold; Big Tech Earnings This Week; MN and National Gas Edge Down

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	Friday (23 OCT) the Dow fell 1.2%, the S&P 500 0.5%, and the Nasdaq 0.2%, leaving the S&P and Nasdaq with back-to-back weekly losses; WTI settled at $103.27 (+~4%) and Brent at its highest close since April (Investing.com.au; FX Leaders; CNBC). On Sunday evening Brent fell about 1.1% to around $115 and WTI about 1.2% to around $102, and Dow futures rose 143 points (0.3%), S&P futures 0.4%, and Nasdaq-100 futures 0.6% (CNBC). X News summaries on Monday morning put Brent around $114 and WTI near $101 (not verified against an exchange quote). CME FedWatch shows about a 90.6% chance the Fed holds at 3.75%–4.00% on Wednesday (Investing.com.au). Bloomberg reports the Fed raised rates in September and signaled another hike was likely this year, with economists expecting it in December; Bank of America expects a 25 bp hike this week. This is Chair Kevin Warsh's meeting (FX Leaders). Alphabet and Microsoft report Wednesday after the close and Amazon on Thursday. PCE is due 29 OCT (carried forward). AAA national regular fell to $4.2858 from $4.2892; national diesel rose to $6.3492 (AAA, 26 OCT).
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	Oil above $100 and a Fed that hiked in September mean the economy goes into the election with tight money and high fuel costs. The Fed's tone on Wednesday and any Iran decision are the two biggest swing factors for rates, gas, and markets this week.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	CNBC live updates (25 OCT); Investing.com.au and FX Leaders (25 OCT); Bloomberg via swissinfo (25 OCT); Federal Reserve FOMC calendar; AAA (26 OCT); X News summary (Monday oil).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	No right-leaning market coverage was found this period.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	CNBC tied the oil dip to a quiet weekend and the Houthi fighting. Bloomberg quoted BofA's Michael Hartnett: "We stay tactically risk-off until mid-Nov."
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on Friday closes and Sunday futures (multiple outlets). MODERATE on the Monday oil levels (summary). MODERATE on the Fed probability (single cited source).

ITEM 7: Russia–Ukraine — Russia Fires 4 Missiles and 140 Drones Overnight; Oleshky Ceasefire Due 27 OCT as Moscow Accuses Kyiv of Shelling the Town; Deaths Reported in Voronezh

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	Overnight into 26 OCT, Russia launched 4 missiles and 140 drones. Ukraine's air force said 115 targets were neutralized (3 guided missiles and 112 drones), with impacts at 15 locations (RBC-Ukraine; LB.ua). At least nine people were injured in the Zaporizhzhia, Chernihiv, and Kharkiv regions, and homes, warehouses, and grain storage were damaged (Hromadske). TASS said Russia targeted logistics, energy, and port sites, including substations and Chornomorsk port infrastructure. BBC Ukrainian reports deaths in Russia's Voronezh region from a Ukrainian attack; details were not confirmed here. Reuters reports Russia says Ukraine repeatedly struck Oleshky with artillery and drones ahead of the local ceasefire, which is due to begin 27 OCT for aid delivery and voluntary evacuation; Ukraine did not immediately respond (Reuters via Investing.com; AP). The duration of the pause and whether it will hold are not confirmed.
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	The Oleshky ceasefire, brokered with Melania Trump's involvement, is a small test of US-backed de-escalation. Mutual accusations on the eve of it raise the risk it fails, which would weaken the case for the larger Abu Dhabi talks around 10 NOV. Strikes on Ukrainian energy and ports also affect grain exports going into winter.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	RBC-Ukraine, LB.ua, Hromadske (26 OCT); TASS (26 OCT); BBC News Ukrainian (26 OCT, headline only); Reuters via Investing.com and AP (Oleshky, via search summaries).

MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	No right-leaning coverage was found this period.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	AP explained the “Melania Trump-brokered ceasefire.” Ukrainian outlets emphasized civilian damage, and TASS framed the strikes as hits on military logistics.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on the size of the Russian strike (Ukrainian air force figures, multiple outlets). MODERATE on the Oleshky timing (agreed, unverified). LOW on the Voronezh deaths (single headline).

ITEM 8: Domestic / Midterms and Minnesota — Trump in Port Huron Calls El-Sayed a “Jihadist”; Ninth Circuit Skeptical of DOJ’s California Ballot Bid; No New Omar or MN Evidence Court Action

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	At a 25 OCT rally in Port Huron, Michigan, for Senate nominee Mike Rogers and governor nominee John James, Trump said, “I’m here to keep a jihadist Muslim Brotherhood member from becoming a United States Senator,” referring to Democratic nominee Abdul El-Sayed. He said El-Sayed “would be the only senator that will have to go through a metal detector,” and that “Any Jewish person that supports this guy should be ASHAMED of themselves.” He also said, “from Somalia, I’ve had it with them. I much prefer Denmark,” and tied France’s unrest to immigration (TheBlaze clips; AP; Washington Post; MLive). AP reports El-Sayed denied extremist ties and Arab American supporters called the remarks racist. In a Sunday argument that ran about twice its allotted hour, a Ninth Circuit panel (Bennett, Sanchez, Bumatay) sounded skeptical of DOJ’s emergency request to make California set aside ballots from about 20,000 voters DOJ says are likely noncitizens. Judge Bennett, a Trump appointee, asked, “How can we do that?” No ruling was issued. Election law scholar Rick Hasen expects a 2–1 or 3–0 loss for DOJ, possibly followed by a Supreme Court request (AP; Politico; NBC; Election Law Blog). District Judge David O. Carter has set DOJ’s TRO request for argument on 27 OCT (Jurist). On Omar, no charges or new filings were found; she said 22 OCT that she will move out of the DC home searched on 12 OCT (AP via PBS). Search summaries say DOJ’s response on unsealing the warrant records is due 27 OCT, which conflicts with the earlier report that DOJ asked for an extension to 09 NOV (see gaps). Minnesota’s request for a court order forcing federal agencies to share Good/Pretti evidence (officers’ phones, interview recordings, firearms, casings, Pretti’s gun) has had no ruling; DOJ says it can decline absent formal proceedings (CBS Minnesota; PBS; AP).
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	The Michigan Senate race has become a national test of Trump’s attacks on a Muslim candidate. The California ruling, and any Supreme Court appeal, could set rules for challenging ballots days before 03 NOV. For Minnesotans, the Somalia remarks and the uncharged Omar investigation keep the state’s Somali community in the campaign spotlight.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	TheBlaze X clips (25 OCT); AP, Washington Post, MLive (Port Huron); AP, Politico, NBC, Election Law Blog, Jurist (Ninth Circuit); AP via PBS (Omar, 22 OCT); CBS Minnesota, PBS, AP (MN evidence).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	TheBlaze clipped the rally lines on El-Sayed, Somalia, and France. Daily Wire’s District Club said Trump is making the midterms “more of his problem than he needed to” and discussed two pollsters accused of fabricating midterm data. Tim Pool called a Somaliland account’s claim that Omar shared classified committee details “wild.”
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	The Washington Post called it an escalation of “anti-Muslim attacks.” Politico said the appeals court “appears poised to reject” DOJ’s “last-minute bid.”
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on the rally quotes (video). HIGH on the tenor of the Ninth Circuit argument (multiple outlets). HIGH that no new Omar or MN evidence ruling was found.

MN / US COST SNAPSHOT

RESIDENTIAL ELECTRICITY (MN)	17.20¢/kWh for August 2026 vs a US average of 18.16¢/kWh (EIA Electric Power Monthly Table 5.6.A, released 23 OCT 26; no new month).

REGULAR GASOLINE (MN)	$4.1921/gal (AAA Minnesota, 26 OCT 26); yesterday $4.1991; week ago $4.2533; month ago $4.3543; year ago $2.8870. National AAA regular $4.2858, down from $4.2892 (AAA, 26 OCT 26).
DIESEL (MN)	$6.2193/gal (AAA Minnesota, 26 OCT 26); yesterday $6.2199; week ago $6.2081; month ago $6.3073; year ago $3.6134. National AAA diesel $6.3492, up from $6.3474 (AAA, 26 OCT 26).
GROUND BEEF (MN PROXY)	$7.253/lb for September 2026, all uncooked ground beef, Midwest Census Region urban (BLS via FRED APU0200FC1101; checked 26 OCT 26); August $7.317. Not Minnesota-specific.
GOLD SPOT	$4,019.30/troy oz (gold-api.com XAU/USD, 26 OCT 26 ~0724 CDT / 1224 UTC), up from $3,996.90 on 25 OCT. This is a proxy feed, not Kitco/LBMA.
US NATIONAL DEBT	$40,444,342,709,389.15 total public debt outstanding (Treasury Debt to the Penny, record date 22 OCT 26; no newer posting as of 26 OCT).

OPEN THREADS CARRIED FORWARD

Iran	Trump's deal-or-strike decision vs the no-strike-before-03 NOV pledge; outcome of the 26 OCT Tehran meeting with Saudi, Pakistani, and Turkish officials; USS Theodore Roosevelt and 13th MEU arrival; Israel's 27 OCT election; Iran's seven conditions vs the US enrichment demand; Pezeshkian–Putin meeting (no date found).
Hormuz	identity of the 182-26 and 181-26 tankers; the IRGC ship claims; the Sirik launcher report; Gem No. 2 spill containment; next JMIC update; undersea cable threat.
Force protection	the NYT-reported Iranian targeting of US diplomats; further embassy drawdowns and travel limits; US casualty count (21 per the Pentagon via Al Jazeera).
Saudi/Yemen	Houthi targeting of the reopened Riyadh airport; claimed pumping-station hits; coalition strikes; Aramco Dhahran status; any US decision on the Houthis.
Economy	FOMC decision 28 OCT; PCE 29 OCT; Alphabet, Microsoft, Amazon earnings; Canada tariff changes 30 OCT; DPA project selections; DOE SPR exchange award (still not found).
Russia/Ukraine	Oleshky ceasefire from 27 OCT; Abu Dhabi talks around 10 NOV; Starlink/Musk role.
Omar investigation	unseal deadline (27 OCT vs 09 NOV; unresolved); any charges (none found).
Minnesota	ruling on the Good/Pretti evidence request (none found); early voting.
DOJ and elections	Ninth Circuit ruling and any Supreme Court appeal; Judge Carter's 27 OCT TRO hearing; Alaska certification suit.

UNCONFIRMED / QUARANTINED

- Reports that an IRGC anti-ship missile launcher near Sirik, Hormozgan, was struck on 25 OCT after firing toward the strait, possibly by a US jet, and of a separate explosion in Tehranpars: Iranian activist Telegram posts and OSINT sites only; no US or Iranian confirmation.
- Houthi claims of a ballistic missile hit on Riyadh's King Khalid airport (26 OCT) and drone hits on Saudi oil pumping stations: Saudi Arabia says the missile was intercepted; no confirmation of damage.
- X summary that Sharjah also closed beaches over the Gem No. 2 spill: not confirmed by a primary source.
- A Somaliland-linked X account's claim that Omar shared classified committee details in Somalia in 2022: no corroboration found.

Carry-forward	the Iran army claim of downing a US LUCAS drone over Bandar Abbas; the IRGC two-supertanker and seven-ship claims; Ambassador Moghadam's Hormuz-for-blockade offer (denied by Iranian outlets); unattributed Israeli strikes on Iraqi militia MANPADS stores; Trump's 301% Iran inflation figure.

GAPS AND NOTES

- UKMTO 182-26 was read from the PDF on ukmto.org. It is a time-late report for 23 OCT, the same day as 181-26; whether it is the same tanker is not stated.
- AP's 25 and 26 OCT stories, the AP Michigan rally story, and the AP Omar story timed out on fetch; their details come from search summaries and the PBS reprint.
- The Omar unseal deadline conflicts between sources (27 OCT in a search summary vs a 09 NOV extension request reported earlier); not resolved this run.
- Ghalibaf's remarks, the Fars warning to Germany, the spill extent, and Monday oil levels come from X News summaries, not primary sources.
- Treasury has not posted a debt figure after 22 OCT. EIA electricity is unchanged (August 2026). Gold is a proxy feed.

Right-leaning coverage

X feeds of TheBlaze, Glenn Beck, Daily Wire, Tim Pool/Timcast, Timcast News, Steven Crowder, and S2 Underground were searched from 1220 UTC on 25 OCT. Found: TheBlaze's Port Huron rally clips, Obama and Harris clips, and a Talarico jab; Daily Wire's District Club on Trump's campaigning, Vivek Ramaswamy's ad, and pollster fabrication claims; Tim Pool on Candace Owens and the Omar claim; Glenn Beck asking prayers for "Keith," who his post says has locked-in syndrome. No Crowder or S2 Underground posts, and no right-leaning coverage of Iran, Hormuz, Saudi Arabia, or Ukraine, were found.